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32 STUDENTS KILLED IN PAKISTAN SCHOOL ROOF COLLAPSE

A rescue worker carries an injured child after rescuing him from the rubble of a roof collapse at a private school, in Peshawar, Pakistan, yesterday. The roof collapse in Pakistan's northwestern city killed a teacher and 32 students, mostly aged under 14, health officials said, as residents and rescuers scrambled to pull children from the rubble. Twenty more students were taken to hospital after the collapse. A spokesman for the emergency rescue service in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province said schoolchildren were crushed and trapped after the roof gave way. Images released by the emergency services showed rescue workers in high-visibility vests scrambling to move debris, rubble and dirt. SEE ALSO P10

UAE rolls out $1m fund to support 100 creators

Programme aims to help promising ideas develop into sustainable businesses

DUBAI

BY TRICIA GAJITOS
Reporter

An initiative called "100 Dreams" will support 100 aspiring entrepreneurs from around the world who want to build creator-led businesses, production companies, digital media platforms, and other innovative ventures in the media industry.

Aspiring entrepreneurs looking to turn their media and content creation ideas into businesses will now have the opportunity to receive funding, mentorship, and support to establish companies in the UAE through a new $1 million initiative launched ahead of the 1 Billion Followers Summit 2027.

Launched by the 1 Billion Followers Summit in collaboration with global content creator Simon Squibb and with the support of the National Media Authority, the programme aims to help promising ideas develop into sustainable businesses while strengthening the UAE's creator economy.

Applications will open on November 20, with interested entrepreneurs able to register through the Joindream website.

'Content for Good'

The initiative forms part of the fifth edition of the 1 Billion Followers Summit, to take place in Dubai from January 8 to 10 next year, under the theme "Content for Good." Organised by the UAE Government Media Office, the summit is dedicated to advancing the global creator economy.

Each of the 100 selected participants will receive $10,000 in funding to help get their business off the ground, alongside practical assistance to establish a company in the UAE. The package includes UAE company licensing support, assistance with the Golden Visa process subject to government approval, and a trip to Dubai to attend the 1 Billion Followers Summit in January.

Participants will also join a six-week kickstart programme, working with Squibb and the Dream team to develop their ideas and take the first steps towards launching their businesses.

The initiative is open to applicants worldwide aged 18 and above. Eligible ideas can span content creation and creator-led businesses, entertainment and digital media, video and film production, media technology and platforms, and innovative media business models.

SEE ALSO P4



FRIDAY

Alfred Holdings Founder and Chairman on growth and humanity in business

UAE LEADERS CONDOLE WITH SAUDI KING OVER ATTACK VICTIMS

Victims of Riyadh airport strikes remembered

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The Saudi-led coalition said yesterday that the Iran-backed Houthis had attacked Riyadh's airport 20 times this month.

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has sent a message of condolences to the Custodian of the Two Holy Mosques King Salman Bin Abdulaziz Al Saud of Saudi Arabia, expressing his sincere condolences and sympathy over the victims of attacks on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, which resulted in several deaths and injuries. He also wished the injured a speedy recovery.

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, His Highness Sheikh Dr Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Supreme Council Member and Ruler of Sharjah, His Highness Sheikh Saud Bin Saqr Al Qasimi, Supreme Council Member and Ruler of Ras Al Khaimah and Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, sent similar messages to the Saudi King.

Multiple attacks

The Saudi-led coalition said yesterday that the Iran-backed Houthis had attacked Riyadh's airport 20 times this month, as the Yemeni group escalated its strikes on the kingdom's transport hubs and oil facilities.

During a presentation in Riyadh covering the strikes, coalition spokesman Turki Al Malki said "the Houthis must immediately cease all terrorist operations targeting civilians and civilian facilities, including airports, ports, oil facilities, and infrastructure."

Meanwhile, the Saudi-led coalition yesterday said it had intercepted a cruise missile in the Madina region — home to one of Islam's holiest cities that the Houthis previously vowed not to target.

10 ships struck

Attacks on vessels in and around the Strait of Hormuz have also intensified, with at least 10 ships struck since Sunday, the highest number over the period since the US-Israel war with Iran began.

Iran's IRGC claimed a container ship laden with more than 2,500 containers was struck by a naval mine and sank south of the Strait of Hormuz.

US forces destroyed an Iranian-affiliated dhow in the Gulf of Oman on October 6 after identifying it as conducting surveillance and targeting US Navy ships, US Central Command (CENTCOM) said in a post on X. CENTCOM said the vessel's crew members were safely removed before the dhow was destroyed, adding that efforts to repatriate them are ongoing.

Most intense blockade

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said yesterday that the country was facing its most intense blockade since the 1979 Islamic Revolution, accusing the United States of seeking to provoke public protests.

"Over the 48 years since the Revolution, we have never faced such intense blockade, war and difficulties as we are facing now," Pezeshkian said in a speech broadcast by state television. He accused Washington of seeking to make life difficult for Iranians in order to fuel public anger and trigger unrest.

Houthi strike kills 4 in Aden

Elsewhere, at least four people were killed and 10 more wounded in a Houthi missile attack yesterday on the presidential palace in Yemen's Aden, which also serves as the internationally recognised government's headquarters, three government military sources told AFP.

SEE ALSO P6

IN FOCUS



WILDLIFE PHOTOGRAPHER OF THE YEAR UNVEILED

Winning photographs capture extraordinary moments across habitats, from underwater ecosystems and urban environments to intimate encounters revealing animal behaviour | P8-9



ABU DHABI

F1 2026 will be bigger than 2025, says CEO of Ethara | P111

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